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EXPERIENCE

Lead Data Engineer | Unmind

OCT 2022 – PRESENT

Initially hired as the sole data engineer, I inherited a dysfunctional data platform. In my time at Unmind so far I have rebuilt the foundations of the data platform from the ground up, based on the principles of the Modern Data Stack with a heavy focus on solid OSS tooling (Airbyte, Dagster and dbt) and fostering a high-skill strong-delivery team culture. I always build with leverage in mind; something that takes a week today should take 10 minutes in 6 months. This has been impactful in that we can now integrate new data sources at 10x the speed we could before, we can now be confident of data quality and correctness, and we know when problems are happening, why they are happening and how to fix them. We can also now (GDPR) compliantly analyse data containing sensitive information due to the design of the system. I bias towards action and getting things done. I have also been managing a direct report, giving 1-1 sessions as well as providing technical mentorship.

Senior Software Engineer | Airbyte

JUN 2021 – OCT 2022

Joined Airbyte as one of the first 10 engineers, working on all parts of the platform; from connector frameworks to platform code to cloud release work & our partner API. Engaged often with the 8000+ strong open-source community via Github and Slack to answer their questions, review open source community contributions and take on their feedback as a user-centric decision maker. As the team grew I landed firmly in the connectors extensibility team, working on cross cutting projects in python and java to build leverage around our long tail of connectors. This role was a purposeful shift from lead/management into pure software engineering enabling me to rapidly and exponentially scale my technical skillset.

Technical Lead – Data Engineering | Mars

JAN 2021 – JUN 2021

Continuation of previous role, with the team I managed growing to >15 people.

Senior Data Engineer | Mars (contractor)

JUL 2020 – JAN 2021

This role has involved leading a team of 4 – 8 developers, helping them to develop with weekly one-to-one sessions, as well as taking point on the design and technical lead of multiple projects. I push my team to build their skills and excel, this has led to two engineers being accepted to speak at the next Databricks Data+AI summit. The continued building of *Kyte* (detailed below) has been focused on packaging the code for shared contribution and use across the wider Mars landscape, focusing on the user experience and benefits. Also overseeing development of *Gecko*, a Spark-based compliance framework to encrypt and secure all data across the platform.

Conceptualised and built *Dynamo*, a Spark based dynamic transformation engine. Engaged with external stakeholders at WALTHAM Petcare Science Institute as lead and project manager to ingest and serve modelled data to their data science team (utilising *Kyte* and *Dynamo*). Mentored junior engineers and delivered various knowledge transfer sessions across many subjects (see Technical Skills below). Starting leading the deployment of the Petcare Data Platform to the UK, Russia and China.

Data Engineer | Mars (contractor)

JAN 2019 – JUL 2020

Built and implemented new practices and frameworks for the team, including ingestion tracking, custom logging with instant alerts, clear structure for projects, optimisation of code, cost awareness and monitoring. Led detailed technical investigation on platform tech, working alongside heads of data engineering and architecture, resulting in driving the decision for using Delta Lake as our key platform format. Built many hours' worth of training content from scratch to upskill the team in Spark and Databricks. Delivered these materials many times across Mars divisions. Worked on Azure Data Factory maintaining and building ingestion pipelines. Reinvigorated this process by leading the design and team building *Kyte*, a bespoke Databricks Spark based EL(T) framework. The team rapidly expanded with this new capability at its core. Continued to lead on *Kyte* enhancements and a targeted refactor to refine standards and convert key functionality to an Object-Oriented structure. Presented *Kyte* at the Databricks Spark+AI Summit mid 2020 (link at end of CV).

Data Engineer | Kubrick Group

SEP 2018 – JAN 2019

Undertook the intense Kubrick Data Engineer training programme to gain industry-ready skills in key data technologies (SQL, Python, Spark, ML, Hadoop, Tableau, networking, web frameworks). Led the data engineering half within the training group for a successful live client project web scraping publicly available data. Selected to represent Kubrick in a hackathon at a leading insurance firm in London.

Operations & Logistics Intern | Uber

JUL 2015 – SEP 2015

Varied, high intensity internship during university within the small team starting up Uber in Manchester. Was assigned to oversee logistics and layout of move to a new office. Designed a virtual 3D model of the new office as a tool to visualise and plan the transfer. Built valuable soft skills on-boarding new drivers in cohorts and working with current drivers to solve problems.



EDUCATION

MSc Contemporary Person-Centred Psychotherapy and Applications |

Metanoia Institute

2022 - PRESENT

- A passion of mine: Part-time MSc training to be an accredited psychotherapist.

BSc (Hons) Management – 2:1 | University of Manchester (AMBS)

2014 - 2018

- Modules in Economics (Macro/Micro), Finance, Leadership, Management Psychology & Sociology, Accounting, Marketing, Quantitative Methods, Organisational Structure.
- Included a year studying abroad at New York University's Stern School of Business.



TECHNICAL SKILLS

Advanced

- Python, Java
- Spark & Databricks
- Modern data stack -> Airbyte, dbt, Dagster
- Docker
- Terraform, Infrastructure as Code
- APIs, Cloud data lakes / file systems
- ETL Design & Development, data modelling
- SQL & Relational Databases (PostgreSQL, MSSQL, Oracle, SQLite)
- Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Azure
- GitHub, GitLab, Azure DevOps, CI/CD
- Object Oriented Programming (OOP), integration & unit testing
- Agile working (Sprints, Kanban, etc.)
- Linux, bash scripting, (S)FTP

Intermediate

- Scala, PowerShell, html/css/php/js
- Flask, Django, JDBC/ODBC, Redis, MongoDB, Salesforce, Neo4j, Snowflake
- Airflow
- Hardware and networking infrastructure
- Web Scraping, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing
- Detailed understanding of file formats, encoding and compressions (Delta Lake, Parquet, CSV, JSON, XML, gzip, zip, zlib, snappy etc.)

Spark+AI Summit talk: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6aQJvfFmjsI>